



How to check an invoice is correct: a checklist and 8 messages (2026)

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

Checklists and first messages

Before you send an invoice

- [] My name and address, and the client's
- [] Invoice number, and I have not used it before
- [] Invoice date and due date
- [] Each line matches the quote or the agreement
- [] Quantity x price is right on every line
- [] Subtotal, discount and tax work out
- [] Currency is shown
- [] Payment details are right
- [] The total matches my own working

Before you pay an invoice

- [] I know this supplier and the work was done
- [] The lines match the quote or order
- [] I have not paid this invoice before
- [] The totals work out
- [] The bank details match the last invoice. If they changed, I phoned a number I already had to check.

The sums, step by step

1. For each line, multiply quantity by unit price.
2. Add the lines to get the subtotal.
3. Take off any discount.
4. Work out the tax on the amount, at the rate shown on the invoice.
5. Add the tax to get the total.
6. Compare your total with the one on the invoice. If they differ, find the line that does not match.

Pointing out a mistake on an invoice you received

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: a question on line [LINE]

Hi [FIRST NAME],

Thank you for invoice [NUMBER]. Line [LINE] shows [WHAT IT SHOWS], but the quote said [WHAT IT SAID]. Could you check it and send a corrected invoice?

I will pay it within [TERMS] of receiving the corrected one.

[YOUR NAME]

Correcting your own invoice

Subject: Corrected invoice [NUMBER]

Hi [FIRST NAME],

I made a mistake on invoice [NUMBER]: [WHAT WAS WRONG]. The corrected invoice is attached. Please pay that one and ignore the first. Sorry for the trouble.

[YOUR NAME]

More messages about invoices

Ask a client to confirm their details first

Subject: Before I send the invoice: please check these details

Hi [NAME],

Before I send the invoice for [PROJECT], could you check these details? Company name: [NAME]. Address: [ADDRESS]. Who should receive it: [EMAIL]. Do you need a PO number or a reference on it? Reply with any changes and I will use them.

Thanks,

[YOUR NAME]

A purchase order number is missing

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: PO number needed?

Hi [NAME],

Is there a purchase order number for invoice [NUMBER]? The invoice does not show one. If your accounts team needs it before they can pay, please send it and I will issue a corrected invoice the same day.

Ask for a credit note for an overcharge

Subject: Invoice [NUMBER]: please issue a credit note

Hi [NAME],

On invoice [NUMBER] I was charged [AMOUNT] for [ITEM]. The agreed price was [AMOUNT] on [DATE, QUOTE OR EMAIL]. Please send a credit note for the difference of [AMOUNT] and a corrected invoice. I will pay the correct amount as soon as I have it.

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